MyAccounting — Installation Guide

Document version: 1.0
Application version: 1.0.0
Date: April 18, 2026
Author: Daniel Seguin

> **Who is this guide for?**
> This guide walks anyone through installing MyAccounting on a Windows computer. No technical background is needed — the installation wizard does all the heavy lifting for you.

Table of Contents

1. What the Installer Does For You
2. Before You Start
3. Step-by-Step Installation Walkthrough
4. First Sign-In
5. After Installation — What to Do Next
6. Troubleshooting

---

1. What the Installer Does For You

The MyAccounting installer (`deploy.exe`) is a guided wizard. You simply answer a few questions about your business and click **Next** — the installer takes care of everything else automatically:

What It Does	Details
Checks your system	Verifies Windows version and available disk space
Installs SQL Server Express	If no database engine is found, downloads and installs Microsoft SQL Server 2022 Express (free, ~500 MB)
Installs the database driver	Downloads and installs ODBC Driver 17 for SQL Server if not already present
Creates the database	Creates the `myaccounting` database and all required tables
Loads your Chart of Accounts	Pre-loads a ready-to-use set of financial categories tailored to your industry
Sets up your company profile	Saves your company name, address, and email settings directly into the application
Creates your admin account	Creates the initial administrator login with the password you choose
Creates shortcuts	Adds a desktop shortcut and Start-Menu entry for MyAccounting

> **Internet connection required** — only during installation if SQL Server Express or the ODBC driver needs to be downloaded. After installation, the application runs entirely offline.

---

2. Before You Start

Requirement	Details
Operating System	Windows 10 or later (64-bit)
Disk Space	At least 500 MB free (for the database engine and application files)
Internet	Required only if SQL Server Express or ODBC Driver 17 need to be downloaded
Administrator Rights	The installer must run as Administrator — Windows will ask you to confirm

> **Note:** If SQL Server is already installed on your computer (for example, if another program uses it), the installer will use the existing installation.

---

3. Step-by-Step Installation Walkthrough

Step 1 — Welcome Screen

Double-click `deploy.exe` to start the wizard.

If Windows asks *"Do you want to allow this app to make changes to your device?"*, click **Yes**. The installer needs administrator rights to install SQL Server and create shortcuts.

The Welcome screen summarises what the installer will do. Click **Next**.

Step 2 — System Requirements Check

The wizard automatically checks whether your computer already has:

- SQL Server Express (the database engine)
- ODBC Driver 17 for SQL Server (the database connector)
- Enough free disk space (minimum 500 MB)

If something is missing, the wizard downloads and installs it silently. You will see progress messages in the log area. This step may take several minutes if SQL Server needs to be downloaded — this is normal.

Status Icon	Meaning
✅	Found or installed successfully
❌	Not found or installation failed
⏳	Currently checking or installing

When all three show ✅, click **Next** to continue.

> **If an item shows ❌** — see the Troubleshooting section below.

Step 3 — Installation Directory

Choose the folder where MyAccounting will be installed.

The default is `C:\Program Files\MyAccounting`. You can click **Browse...** to pick a different location. The available free space on the selected drive is shown below the field.

Click **Next**.

Step 4 — Select Your Industry

Choose the industry that best describes your business. The wizard will pre-load a set of financial categories (Chart of Accounts) designed for that industry so you don't have to set them up from scratch.

Available industries and example included categories:

Industry	Typical Revenue Categories Included
IT Consultant	Consulting Revenue, Software Development, Training, Support & Maintenance, Cloud Services
Real Estate	Rental Income, Commission Income, Property Management Fees
Construction	Contract Revenue, Progress Billing, Change Order Revenue
Healthcare	Patient Services, Insurance Reimbursements, Lab Fees
Transportation	Freight Revenue, Passenger Revenue, Charter Services
Retail	Sales Revenue, Cost of Goods Sold
Manufacturing	Product Sales, Raw Materials, Direct Labor
Education	Tuition, Grants, Workshop Revenue
Hospitality	Room Revenue, Food & Beverage, Events
Finance	Interest Income, Advisory Fees, Commissions
Agriculture	Crop Sales, Livestock Sales, Government Subsidies
Entertainment	Ticket Sales, Streaming & Licensing, Merchandise
Non-Profit	Donations, Grants, Program Revenue, Membership Dues

When you select an industry, the right panel shows a preview of all the accounts that will be loaded. You can add, rename, or remove accounts later in the application under **Configuration** → **Chart of Accounts**.

Click **Next**.

Step 5 — Company Information

Enter your business details. This information will appear on every invoice and report the application produces.

Field	What to Enter
Company Name	Your business name (required)
Address Line 1	Street address
Address Line 2	Suite, unit, PO Box (optional)
City	City
Province / State	Province or state
Postal / ZIP Code	Postal code
Country	Country
Phone	Business phone number
Fax	Fax number (optional)
Email	Your business email address
Website	Your website URL (optional)

You can update any of this later in **Configuration** → **Company Info**.

Click **Next**.

Step 6 — Email Settings

MyAccounting can send invoices and timesheets directly by email. Enter your outgoing email server details here.

Field	What to Enter
SMTP Host	Your email server (e.g., `smtp.gmail.com`, `smtp.office365.com`)
SMTP Port	Usually `587` (Gmail, Office 365) or `465` (some providers)
SMTP Username	The email address emails are sent from
SMTP Password	Password for that email account
Use TLS	Leave checked — this keeps your email connection secure

> **Not sure about these values?** Check with your email provider or IT person. You can also skip this step and configure email later in **Configuration** → **Email Settings**.

Click **Next**.

Step 7 — Administrator Password

Set the password for the built-in `admin` account. This is the master account that can configure everything in the application.

Field	Notes
New Password	At least 8 characters recommended
Confirm Password	Must match exactly

> **Write this password down and keep it safe.** If you lose the admin password, recovering access requires direct database access.

Click **Next**.

Step 8 — Installing

The wizard performs all installation steps in the background. A progress bar and log messages show what is happening:

1. Copying application files to the installation folder
2. Connecting to SQL Server
3. Creating the `myaccounting` database
4. Creating all application tables
5. Loading country, province, and payment term reference data
6. Writing your company settings
7. Creating the admin user account
8. Loading the Chart of Accounts for your selected industry
9. Creating desktop and Start-Menu shortcuts

This step typically takes 1–3 minutes. Do not close the window while it is running.

Step 9 — Done

When the progress bar completes and you see the success message, the installation is finished.

Click **Finish** (or **Launch MyAccounting**) to open the application immediately.

---

4. First Sign-In

After the installer completes, open MyAccounting from the desktop shortcut or Start Menu.

1. At the sign-in screen, enter:
    - **Username:** `admin`
    - **Password:** the password you set in Step 7 of the wizard
2. You are now on the Dashboard.

---

5. After Installation — What to Do Next

The wizard has set up everything you need to start using the application. Here are the recommended first steps:

5.1 Verify Your Company Info

Go to **Configuration** → **Company Info** and confirm your business name, address, and contact details look correct on screen.

5.2 Set Your Fiscal Year and Tax Rate

Go to **Configuration** → **Fiscal Year & Settings** and confirm:

- **Fiscal Year Start / End** — the beginning and end of your financial year (e.g., Jan 1 – Dec 31)
- **Tax Rate** — the HST or GST rate you charge (e.g., 13 for Ontario HST)
- **Accounts Receivable, Revenue, Tax, and Bank account categories** — select the matching accounts from your Chart of Accounts

5.3 Add Your Team Members (Consultants / Staff)

Go to **Configuration** → **Consultants** and add each person who will create invoices or timesheets.

5.4 Add Your First Client

Go to **Configuration** → **Clients** and add your first client. At minimum, enter the company name and email address so you can send them invoices.

5.5 Add Your Services

Go to **Configuration** → **Services** and add the services or items you bill for — with default descriptions and prices.

5.6 Create Your First Invoice

Go to **Invoicing** → **New Invoice**, select a client, add service lines, and click **Save**. Click **Print PDF** to preview it, or **Email** to send it directly to the client.

5.7 Add Additional Users (Optional)

To give a colleague or bookkeeper access to the application, go to **Configuration** → **Users** → **Add User**. You can control exactly which sections each person can access.

---

6. Troubleshooting

SQL Server fails to install

- Make sure you are running the installer as Administrator (right-click `deploy.exe` → **Run as administrator**)
- Temporarily disable antivirus software during installation — some antivirus tools block silent SQL Server installs
- Ensure you have a stable internet connection and at least 500 MB of free disk space

ODBC Driver shows ❌ after installation

- A Windows restart may be required — restart your computer and run the installer again; the wizard will skip already-installed components and continue from where it left off
- Alternatively, download ODBC Driver 17 manually from Microsoft and install it before re-running the wizard

"Cannot connect to SQL Server" after installation

- Open Windows Services (press `Win + R`, type `services.msc`) and verify that **SQL Server (SQLEXPRESS)** is running
- If it is stopped, right-click it and choose **Start**

Application opens but shows a database connection error

- Verify SQL Server is running (see above)
- Ensure the installation completed successfully — check the log on the installer's progress screen for any ❌ messages

Forgot the admin password

Contact your system administrator or the application support team. Password recovery requires direct access to the SQL Server database.

End of Installation Guide